

wildtag.ai

Quick reference guide

This is a condensed cheat sheet for running a project through wildtag.ai from start to finish. For full detail on any setting, see the full manual.

The five tabs, in order

- **Run** — process a folder of camera trap images and tag detections.
- **Validate** — review and correct wildtag's species labels.
- **Distribute** — package validation batches into zips for volunteers.
- **Map** — view detection locations geographically (needs deployment metadata).
- **Summary** — stats, species counts, and the confusion matrix once validated.

One-time setup

1. Unzip wildtag.ai into a permanent folder, don't run it from Downloads or a temporary location.
2. Double-click wildtag.bat to launch.
3. If you have an NVIDIA GPU, accept the one-time prompt to install GPU-enabled PyTorch when offered. This is optional but meaningfully faster.

Standard project workflow

1. Run tab: Browse to your project folder (the one containing an images\ subfolder).
2. Set your confidence thresholds and geographic filter if relevant.
3. Choose CPU or GPU under Performance, and set CPU threads if using CPU.
4. Leave "Sort images into species folders" checked, this is what Validate and Distribute both need.
5. Click Run wildtag and wait. Progress and any issues appear in the log below.
6. Validate tab: browse to validation\ inside your project, review each species folder, correct any wrong labels.
7. Distribute tab (optional): package validation batches into volunteer zips for external review. Max images per zip is configurable, small (default 250) for emailing, large for handing over on a hard drive.
8. When volunteer zips come back, merge their corrections back in via the same Distribute pane.
9. Summary tab: review overall stats and the confusion matrix once validation is complete.

Processing device

- **CPU** — always available, slower. Set threads under Performance, leave one free for the rest of your computer.
- **GPU** — requires an NVIDIA card. If wildtag says "No NVIDIA GPU detected" but you have one, it will offer to install GPU PyTorch automatically on next launch.

If a GPU install completes but wildtag still shows CPU only, this usually means the NVIDIA driver needs updating. Update it from [nvidia.com/drivers](https://www.nvidia.com/drivers), then delete wildtag_settings.json next to wildtag.py to have wildtag check again.

Validate tab tips

- **Green box** — the detection you're reviewing.
- **Expand button (corner of each tile)** — opens that image large, fitted to your screen. Click it or press Esc to close.
- **Amber box** — another detection in the same photo, shown for context, no action needed.
- **Mark batch complete** — does this once you've been through every image in that batch.

If something looks wrong

- **App won't open** — make sure you're double-clicking wildtag.bat, not wildtag.py directly.
- **GPU install loops or fails** — see the driver note above, this is almost always a driver, not a wildtag, issue.
- **Summary asks you to browse to results_with_ids.csv** — make sure you've selected your project folder in the Run tab first, Summary finds it automatically from there.
- **Still stuck** — check the full manual, or reach out to the project lead.